S

SkillOS

MEASURE. DEVELOP. PREDICT. — WORKFORCE CAPABILITY, INTELLIGENTLY.

Varun Kumar

The operating system that proves training changed capability : not just completion

SkillOS is a B2B SaaS platform built for mid-market L&D teams. It runs role-family baseline assessments, retrains through the customer's existing LMS, retests, and outputs a CFO-ready Capability Lift Report. Pricing is per covered employee. Defensibility comes from longitudinal capability data and deep HRIS/LMS integrations — not from AI alone, since any competitor can prompt an LLM.

M MEASURE

Role-family baseline assessments turn scattered LMS activity into a real, defensible capability score — by person, team, and role.

D DEVELOP

Gap-based recommendations, manager nudges, and practice embedded in daily work close the skills that matter most, not the ones that are easiest to teach.

P PREDICT

Longitudinal data plus AI forecast future skill demand, role readiness, and obsolescence risk before the business feels the gap.

39%

of core skills expected to change by 2030

WEF, Future of Jobs 2025

87%

of organisations can't isolate training's impact

ATD Research

$782

spent per learner/yr by US midsize firms

Training magazine, 2025

70%

of training content is forgotten within weeks

McKinsey

TARGET CUSTOMER

Knowledge-work firms, 1,000–5,000 employees, with an L&D/HRops owner, an existing HRIS and an LMS.

BUYER · VALIDATOR · TRIGGER

Head of L&D or CHRO buys · CFO validates · Trigger: budget review, “prove the ROI.”

3-YEAR VISION

System of record for verified capability: ~70 customers, ~$3.6M ARR, predictive workforce readiness.

Land-and-expand: One 90-day pilot proving capability lift on a single role family → a full workforce-capability platform over three years, defended by longitudinal pre/post data and integrations. AI itself is not the moat.

THE PROBLEM

Companies train employees but can't prove capability improved

LMS data proves activity, not impact — and three converging shifts make that gap urgent right now.

THE CURRENT REALITY

1 **Train** — Invest in courses & programs

2 **Complete** — Employees finish courses

3 **Report** — We get completion reports

4 **No clarity** — No visibility into capability

> ***"Did training actually improve our people's capability? Most companies still can't answer this."***

Completion is not capability. You can't improve what you can't measure — and 97% of midsize firms run an LMS that logs hours, not skill.

70%
of learning is forgotten within weeks
McKinsey

$360B+
spent annually on corporate learning globally
Statista

87%
of L&D leaders can't link training to business impact
Deloitte

97%
of midsize firms run an LMS — it logs hours, not capability
Training magazine, 2025

WHAT LEADERS KNOW (ACTIVITY)

- Courses completed 1,248 (+18%) · Enrolled learners 2,356 (+22%)
- Certifications earned 842 (+16%) · Training hours 8,432 (+20%)
- Course completion rate: 82% — visibility into activity is clear and easy

WHAT LEADERS DON'T KNOW (IMPACT)

- Skill improvement? Capability score? — both unknown
- Job readiness? Business impact? — both unknown
- "Are our people actually getting better? I don't know." — no clarity on impact

WHY NOW — THREE SHIFTS ARE CONVERGING

AI adoption is exploding
78% of leaders say AI adoption is a top priority — McKinsey, 2024

Skill obsolescence is accelerating
44% of core skills will change in the next 5 years — WEF, 2023

Internal mobility is a priority
86% of HR leaders say internal mobility is a priority — LinkedIn, 2024

Mid-market is the underserved middle — confirmed by early user interviews

Scores 33/45 vs 29 (enterprise) and 25 (startups); ~2% of SAM (~$3.6M ARR) is enough by Year 3.

ENTERPRISE — 5,000+ employees

Complex legacy systems, long sales cycles, multiple stakeholders. Already served: Workday live at 25%+ of Fortune 500.

Score 29/45 — served, slow to land

MID-MARKET ★ TARGET — 1,000–5,000 employees

Strong need for workforce visibility & skill data. L&D owner + LMS + HRIS already exist. High willingness to invest.

Score 33/45 — right need, right size, right time

STARTUPS — < 200 employees

No dedicated L&D budget or owner; founder trains informally. Capped by headcount — low expansion potential.

Score 25/45 — not enough need or budget yet

TAM ~$1.3B

~7,800 firms × ~2,000 employees × $84/yr (Growth tier)

SAM ~$160M

15.6M × 40% knowledge-work × 30% role-family coverage × $84/yr

SOM ~$3.6M

Y3 target: 70 customers × ~800 employees × ~$65 blended ≈ 2.3% of SAM

MARKET GROWTH & CROSS-CHECK

Corporate learning $370B+ → $580B by 2030 (9.6% CAGR) · Learning analytics $6.1B+ → $17.4B (23.4% CAGR) · 87% say skills-gap risks growth (Deloitte); 2.5× more likely to hire internally by 2025 (LinkedIn)

EARLY USER INTERVIEWS

Method: 10–15 min structured calls — Heads of L&D, CHROs, mid-market CFOs. Early reads validate the wedge and sharpen the pitch.

"We can tell you who finished the course. We can't tell the CFO if anyone got better at their job. That gap is exactly what we'd pay to close."

Head of L&D, SaaS firm (1,800 employees) — remote-first

Confirms the core wedge: completion ≠ capability, and it's the L&D owner's own pain.

"Give me one clean number I can put in a board deck — not a dashboard with forty metrics. If it plugs into our HRIS in under two weeks, I'm in."

CHRO, logistics & supply chain (2,600 employees)

Validates the CFO-ready report as the hook, and fast HRIS/LMS integration as a hard requirement.

"We already spend more per learner than most vendors charge for this. I just need proof it moved the needle before the next budget review."

Mid-market CFO, professional services (1,200 employees)

Supports per-employee pricing against existing L&D spend, and the budget-review trigger.

Buyer · Head of L&D/CHRO Validator · CFO Trigger · budget review, "prove the ROI". Sources: WEF, ATD, Training Industry, Deloitte, LinkedIn, US Census SUSB.

Measure → Develop → Predict, defended by data & integration depth

Measurement is the wedge; iMocha is the closest rival — the edge is packaging, speed and compounding data, not a feature nobody else has.

YEAR 1

1 MEASURE

Baseline → train in existing LMS → retest → CFO-ready Capability Lift report.

What you get: Capability assessments by role, scores & proficiency, real-time dashboards.

YEAR 2

2 DEVELOP

Gap-based recommendations, manager nudges, learning embedded in daily work.

What you get: Personalized learning paths, practice & mentorship, progress tracking.

YEAR 3

3 PREDICT

AI + data forecast future skill needs, readiness and business impact.

What you get: Future skill-demand forecasting, role readiness %, obsolescence alerts.

1 Assessment → 2 Capability Graph → 3 AI Recommendations → 4 Insights

Capability Data

Proprietary longitudinal data across skills, roles, teams & outcomes — hard to replicate, easy to compound.

Benchmarking

Crowdsourced, anonymized cross-company benchmarks — value increases as the network grows.

AI Recommendations

Models trained on capability data improve with every outcome — but any rival can prompt an LLM too.

Integrations

Embedded in Workday, SAP, BambooHR, Slack, Teams, HRIS/LMS/SSO — higher switching costs over time.

Honest note: brand & network effects are weak on day one. AI itself is not the moat — any competitor can generate assessments with an LLM; defensibility is SME-validated items, calibrated rubrics and outcome-labelled data.

COMPETITIVE POSITIONING — WHITESPACE FOR SKILLOS

Workday Skills Cloud	25%+ of Fortune 500 live	Inventory-first, tied to Workday — SkillOS complements, feeds verified proficiency in
Cornerstone Galaxy	Enterprise-first (10K+ users typical)	Suite weight/cost for 1–5K firms — SkillOS overlays the LMS, no migration
Degreed (Skills+)	Global enterprise, sales-led	Content/experience-centred — SkillOS is measurement-first, LXP-agnostic
iMocha	300+ enterprises, assessment-led	Closest rival — we win on one role family, 30-day time-to-value, mid-market price

GO-TO-MARKET & BUSINESS MODEL

Land in 90 days, prove ROI, then expand into a $3.6M-ARR platform

Every roadmap item maps to a strategic objective; per-employee pricing grows automatically as coverage expands.

1 Land One Team

Land · Prove ROI

90-day pilot ($15K, one role family): baseline → retest day 75–90. Goal: establish value & credibility.

2 Prove & Integrate

Integrate · Automate

Gate ≥60% assessed → full HRIS/LMS sync → gap-based recs (Growth upsell). Goal: demonstrate ROI & repeatability.

3 Expand Company-Wide

Expand · Platform

More role families/teams/departments → predictive readiness + open API. Goal: scale impact org-wide.

Expansion triggers: renewal dates · new AI-tool rollout · security scare · budget review · hiring wave/M&A · audit request. Internal pull: managers see peer scores; CFO wants one ROI view; Talent/Compliance reuse verified data.

YEAR 1 — NOW

Assessment engine (3 role families), Capability Lift Report, core integrations, 5 design partners.

Exit: 10 customers (~$0.2M ARR), ≥60% pilot→annual

YEAR 2 — NEXT

Gap-based recs, 10 role families, more connectors, capability graph v1.

Exit: 30 customers (~$1.0M ARR), NRR ≥110%

YEAR 3 — LATER

Predictive readiness, open API, SOC 2/governance, cross-department use.

Exit: 70 customers (~$3.6M ARR), NRR ≥115%

North Star: verified capability gains per quarter. Guardrail: assessment validity (test-retest reliability, dispute rate). Expands: L&D/HR → Talent & mobility → Delivery/Ops → Compliance → Finance.

BUSINESS MODEL — PER COVERED EMPLOYEE, TIERED

Essentials	Growth	Enterprise
$4/emp/mo	$7/emp/mo	Custom
Assessments, scores, dashboards, basic reports	+ AI recommendations, learning paths, advanced analytics	+ Workforce planning, predictive insights, SSO, dedicated CSM

500-employee minimum. Rejected: per-seat (ignores value), usage-based (penalises retesting), per-outcome (best fit, but disputes — revisit Y3), flat fee, hybrid. Priced against $782/learner already spent.

TOP RISKS & MITIGATIONS

Assessment validity	SME-validated items, psychometric review, manager override
Employee trust/privacy	Developmental framing, aggregate-by-default, SOC 2/GDPR/DPDP
Incumbent response	Integrate & feed HCM skills clouds; own outcome-labelled data
Integration complexity	SSO + CSV-first minimum stack; top-3 HRIS connectors first
Low adoption	Paid pilot credited to Y1; tie to a funded programme

KPIs: Acquire/Activate — qualified pilots/mo, time-to-first-baseline ≤30 days • Engage/Value — weekly active admins, median lift/programme • Retain/Expand — pilot→annual ≥60%, logo retention ≥90%, NRR ≥110%

Pricing tiers, pilot fee and roadmap targets are planning assumptions to validate with design partners. ARR = customers × covered employees × ~$65 blended annual price.